

# Mike Rosa — Dallas Regional Chamber | Meeting Prep

---

**When:** Friday, July 10 · 1:30-2:30 PM CT

**Where:** Ascension Coffee, The Star · 3625 The Star Blvd Ste 300, Frisco TX

**Context:** Warm relationship lunch — initiated at Tomorrow Fund Breakfast (May 2026)

---

## BACKGROUND / HISTORY

---

**Mike Rosa** is Senior Vice President of Economic Development at the Dallas Regional Chamber (DRC), the most decorated chamber in North Texas and a perennial National Chamber of the Year honoree. He leads the DRC's corporate relocation and expansion practice — the function responsible for recruiting headquarters to the region.

His track record is elite. Under his tenure the DRC has landed AT&T, Toyota Motor North America, CBRE, McKesson, Charles Schwab, Comerica Bank, Fluor, Hilti North America, Kubota Tractor Corporation, and McLaren Automotive — all HQ decisions. That's not a list; that's a body of work that has materially reshaped the Dallas economy.

Before DRC, Mike spent 14 years at the Fort Worth Chamber of Commerce, rising to lead their economic development department as SVP. He holds a Master of Science in Economic Development and a Bachelor's in Regional Planning, both from the University of Southern Mississippi — one of the few practitioners in the room with a graduate credential in the field.

He also writes for Dallas Innovates, giving him a voice in the regional tech and innovation conversation beyond chamber walls.

### Relationship history with David:

- **May 15:** Exchanged emails on sponsorship allocation ideas — Improving has some active Chamber engagement.
- **May 20-21:** Met at the Tomorrow Fund Breakfast. David followed up with a thank-you, calling out the conversation specifically. Warm first impression.

- **June 22:** David proactively invited Mike to lunch, citing the Tomorrow Fund conversation. Mike responded June 24 and proposed today's date (July 10). He picked the day — good signal.

This is a new relationship, two meetings in, with early warmth. Mike proposed today. That means he's investing, not just accepting.

---

## COMPANY OVERVIEW

---

The **Dallas Regional Chamber** is the principal economic development engine for the 13-county DFW region — 700+ member companies, four strategic pillars, funded through the **Tomorrow Fund** investor community.

### Four pillars:

1. Prosperity & Economic Development — HQ recruiting, business retention, expansion
2. Education, Talent & Workforce — pipeline development, Say Yes to Dallas campaign
3. Public Policy — advocacy at city, state, and federal levels
4. Quality of Life — livability, equity, community investment

### Current posture in 2026:

- DFW led the nation in corporate relocations — 100+ HQ moves 2018-2024, pace accelerating
- AI and tech are the defining story: 19,000 AI professionals in DFW (larger than Austin), \$1.1B+ in startup investment (2024), Google's \$40B Texas data center commitment is live
- The DRC is actively positioning DFW as the premier AI infrastructure destination — which is both a recruiting story and an investor story

**The physical infrastructure is landing, not just the pitch.** The compute layer is going up: Wistron (Nvidia supplier) chose Fort Worth over every other city in the country for its first U.S. AI supercomputing facilities — \$761M, 1.1 million sq ft, 800 jobs at AllianceTexas, 20 minutes from where most regional clients operate. Lambda secured \$700M for a facility in Plano. Texas has 248 data centers in the pipeline statewide. AI engineering is now the fastest-growing job category in DFW. The "emerging market" thesis is done — it arrived.

**One headwind worth knowing:** Governor Abbott recently ordered utilities to charge data centers for their own grid infrastructure costs, and AI regulation is now a stated 2027 legislative priority. Texas's frictionless-expansion

advantage is under pressure. This is early innings, but the era of zero-friction AI buildout in Texas may be shorter than the headline numbers suggest — which creates a consulting angle (power strategy, regulatory risk) that's just starting to surface in client conversations.

**Tomorrow Fund** is the DRC's primary funding vehicle — companies invest in it to support the DRC's work. Improving may already be in this ecosystem (see sponsorship thread). Understanding what Mike is trying to build through the Fund is worth exploring.

---

## IMPROVING'S POSITION

---

This isn't a sales call — but the opportunity is real. Two angles worth holding in mind:

### **1. We're downstream of Mike's wins.**

Every company Mike recruits to DFW eventually needs IT services — digital transformation, application development, AI strategy, platform engineering. Improving is already in North Texas with \$72.5M in regional revenue and a reputation for delivery. When a newly landed HQ is standing up operations and looking for technology partners, Improving should be the name Mike has in his back pocket. That relationship doesn't happen in a pitch; it happens in conversations exactly like this one.

### **2. Thought leadership and mutual platform.**

Mike writes for Dallas Innovates. David is targeting 10 speaking engagements in 2026 and runs the Executive AI Workshop series. The DRC runs events — Tomorrow Fund breakfasts, QBRs, corporate dinners — where AI strategy is increasingly on the agenda. There's a natural exchange here: David brings content and credibility; the DRC provides access to the C-suites of companies Mike recruits.

### **3. Sponsorship / Tomorrow Fund.**

There's already a conversation about sponsorship allocation (May 15 thread). Understanding what Improving is getting for that investment — and whether there's a path to deeper Tomorrow Fund membership — is worth surfacing casually.

No pipeline to advance here. The investment is in the relationship itself.

---

## TALKING POINTS

---

### **1. David has been writing about exactly what Mike has been building — and directed readers to the DRC last week.**

Site Selection Magazine just ranked Dallas the #1 tech hub in North America, ahead of D.C. DFW added more tech jobs than any U.S. metro between 2022 and 2024. Wistron chose Fort Worth over every other city in the country. Lambda put \$700M in Plano. 248 data centers in the Texas pipeline. David published a post on July 2 making the case that DFW isn't emerging — it's emerged — and closed it by telling readers to contact the Dallas Regional Chamber, with a disclosure that Improving is a member. Mike should know that. It signals David isn't just a relationship to maintain; he's a voice already in the market amplifying the DRC's story.

### **2. The companies you recruit eventually need what we do.**

Improving's core work — application development, platform engineering, data, AI — is exactly what a newly headquartered company is standing up. We're not hardware or real estate; we're the services layer that comes in during year one and year two. If there's a moment where Mike can make an introduction to a newly landed company, Improving is a natural fit.

### **3. Executive AI Workshop — could be a DRC event.**

The workshop format (C-suite, 90 minutes, hands-on, no vendor pitch) is something the DRC could bring to its member companies or newly recruited executives. Worth floating. Offer to describe the format and let Mike react.

### **5. What does he need from his network right now?**

Ask it directly. Mike is a connector — knowing what he's trying to solve (a specific sector target, an introduction, a policy angle) creates a genuine opportunity to help. That's how a relationship with someone in his seat gets built.

### **6. There's a regulatory turn coming — and clients aren't ready for it.**

Governor Abbott just ordered utilities to charge data centers for their own grid infrastructure, and AI regulation is on the 2027 legislative agenda. Texas's frictionless-expansion advantage is under pressure earlier than most projections assumed. Ask Mike what he's hearing from recruited companies on energy costs and regulatory posture. It's a credibility question — and Improving can be useful to companies trying to navigate it before the legislature makes those conversations mandatory.